LANTERN HOLLOW

A dark storybook night: painted volumes, firelight against cold shadow, and goofy things hiding in the dark.

Palette measured from your screenshot.
Dark, painterly, no cardboard.

SHADOWS AND FOREST

Void
#010508

Night
#05090E

Deep
#090E14

Forest
#11191F

Haze
#181D23

Slate
#202830

EARTH AND WOOD

Soot
#221E20

Bark
#312B2C

Umber
#463834

Lit ground
#654130

Lit wood
#895F46

Warm fog
#3F393A

FIRE RAMP

Core
#FDEB90

Flame
#F9C45A

Orange
#F08A32

Ember
#C8501F

Ground glow
#7C4F36

The only warm light in the world. Everything it touches turns orange-brown, and everything else stays cold.

COOL LIGHT AND CUES

Moon rim
#6F8FA0

Firefly
#D8E27A

Eyes
#C9D84A

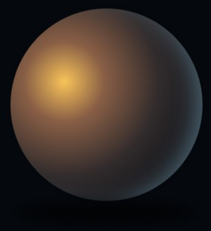
Danger
#5A1D1D

Cream text

Banner

LIGHT RECIPE

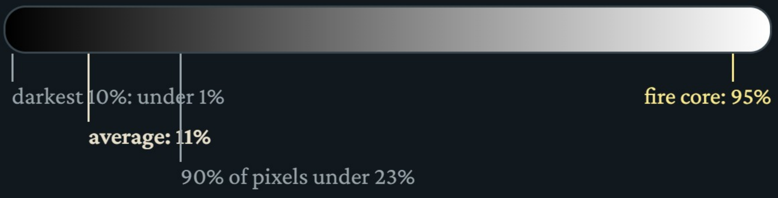
Cardboard: a flat fill and a light cut-out edge. Avoid.



Painted volume: warm key, cool rim, soft contact shadow. Use.

Key: the campfire, #F08A32, flickering about 12% at 6 to 10 Hz. **Ambient:** dark blue #11191F from above. **Rim:** the moon, #6F8FA0, from behind. **Fog:** #181D23, warmer (#3F393A) near the fire.

BRIGHTNESS BUDGET



Measured from your screenshot. The scene is very dark, with the fire as the brightest area. Dark but readable: the player and anything you can use always keep a faint cool rim.

TEXTURES

Ink hatching

Bark fibers

Needle fans

Canvas grain

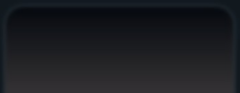
Painted, never glossy. Hatching in the shadows, fibers on wood, fans on pines, and a canvas grain at 6 to 10% over everything.

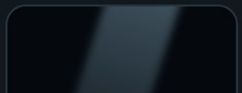
THINGS IN THE DARK

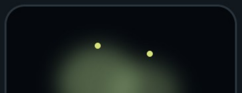
Eyes

Fireflies

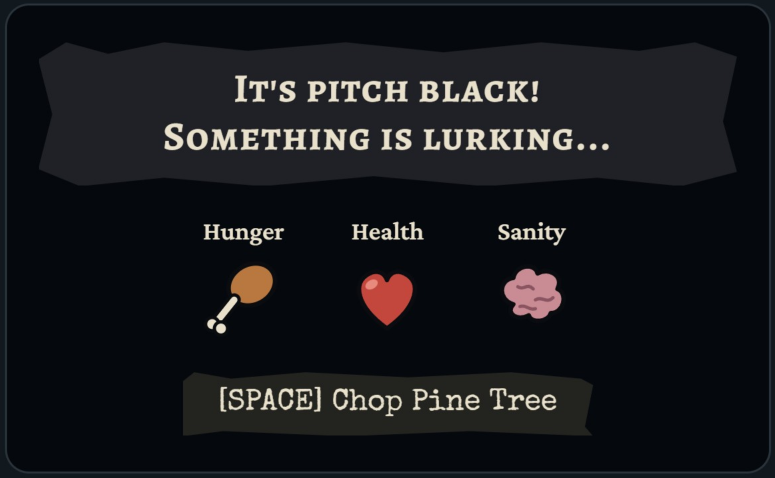
Embers







HUD AND PROMPTS



Dark ink strips with a brushed, ragged edge instead of torn paper. Cream type, small inked icons. Low stats make their icon shake and fade.

TYPE

SOMETHING IS LURKING...

Alegreya SC Bold: banners, titles and buttons.

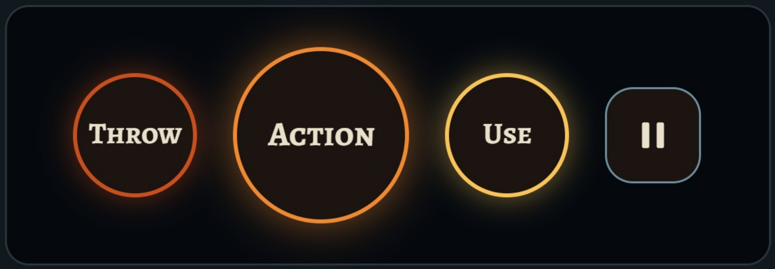
`[SPACE] Chop Pine Tree`

Special Elite: key prompts and notes, like a field journal.

The fire is low and the trees are watching. Gather wood before the dark gets bold.

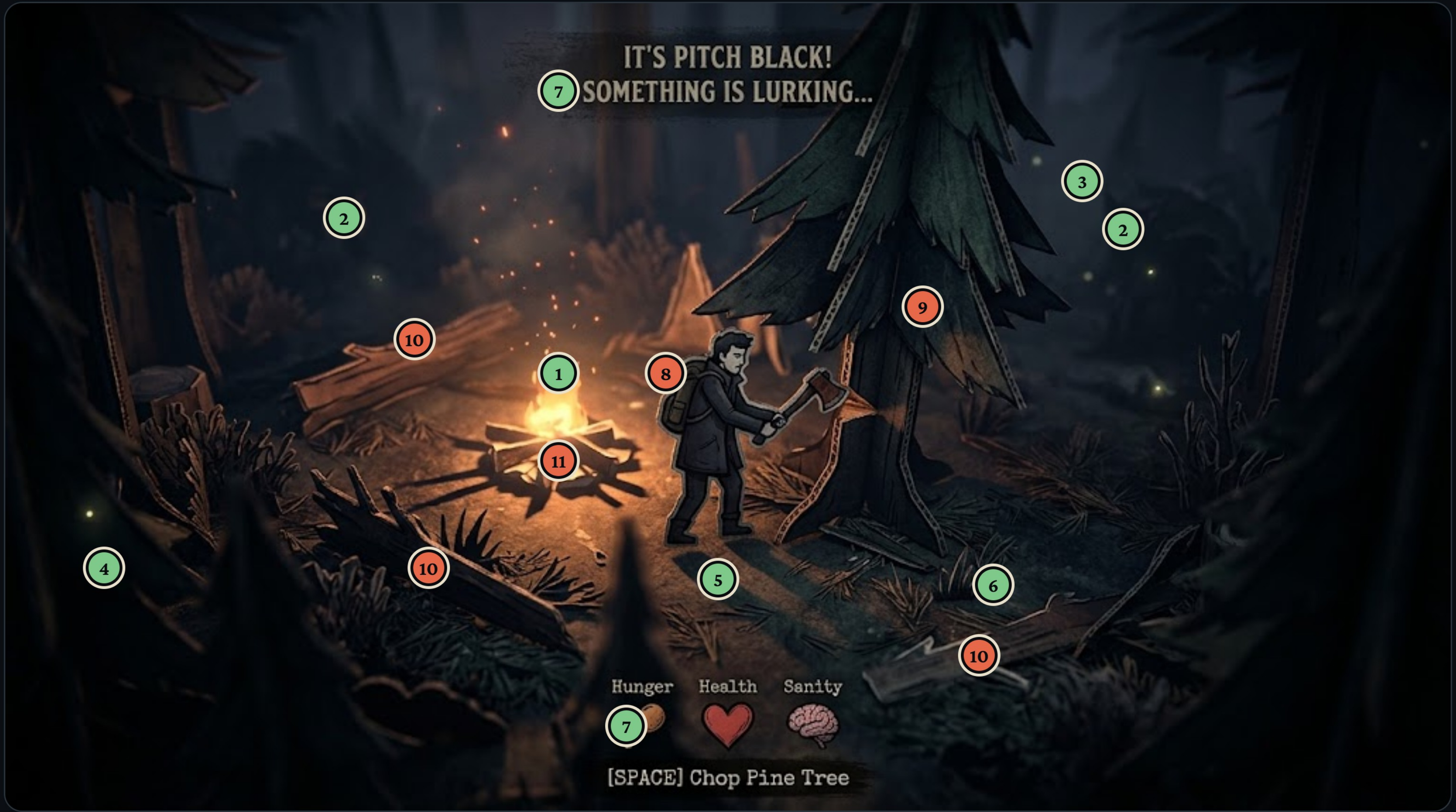
Crimson Pro: reading text and menus. Sound words (bonk, splorp) are small, cream, hand-lettered and fade fast. No neon.

PHONE BUTTONS



Dark ink circles with a thin ring that glows in the role color: ember for action, pale gold for use.

TIME OF DAY



Reference breakdown

Your screenshot, marked up: the mood to keep, and the cardboard look to remove.

Keep

① **Firelight and sparks.** Warm light against cold shadow.

② **Glowing eyes** in the dark. Mood, and a gameplay hint.

③ **Fireflies** as tiny drifting lights.

④ **Blurred dark foreground trees** for depth.

⑤ **Long soft shadows** thrown away from the fire.

⑥ **Brushy, hatched ground** with needles and twigs.

⑦ **Dark ink strips, cream type and small inked icons.** Swap the torn-paper edge for a brushed ink edge.

Change

⑧ **The player** has a pale cut-out edge and flat grey shading. Paint real volume: a warm side facing the fire, a cool rim on the other, and a contact shadow.

⑨ **The pine** is stacked cardboard slabs with torn edges. Use a round painted trunk with bark fibers and needle fans lit from the fire.

⑩ **The logs** are flat slabs. Use round logs with end-grain rings and moss.

⑪ **The campfire sticks** are flat strips. Use round, charred sticks with glowing ends.